Keeping the BP555 clean

Glue from the tape builds up in the brush, tank and blade. A few minutes a week keeps the tape wet, the seal strong and the cut clean.



Supplied by **Cotswold Packaging Group**
Based on the Better Packages 555e User Manual, Rev 3.1

Before you clean anything

Turn off the electrical power first. Main Power Switch to **O** and unplug the machine.

The heater will be hot. Let it cool for at least 30 minutes. If you must move it, hold only the grip tabs on each side.

The cutting blade is extremely sharp. Wear cut-resistant gloves whenever you work near it.

Who does what

WEEKLY	Brush, water tank, water bottle and dust. These come out by hand.
MONTHLY AND ANNUALLY	Blade, felt pads, heater plates and the inside of the machine. Your trained maintenance person, with the power disconnected. The manual calls this Skill B.

The tape glue is non-toxic and water soluble. Soap and water takes it off your hands.

The cleaning schedule

Weekly

- Wash the brush
- Wash the water tank
- Wash the water bottle
- Clear the dust

Monthly

- Scrape glue off the blade
- Oil the back of the blade
- Oil the felt pads

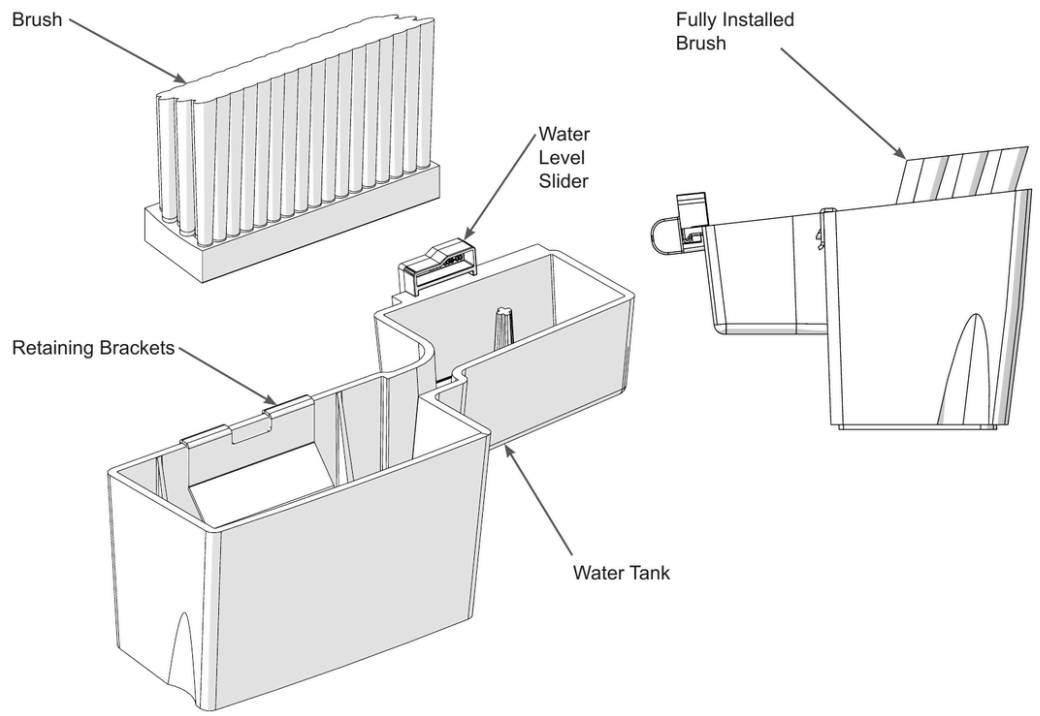
Annually

- Clear tape and dust from inside
- Clean the heater bottom and pressure plates
- Wipe all covers

As needed

- Check the upper tape plate and tape path, especially after a jam

WEEKLY Wash the brush



Manual, Figure 19.

1. Lift out the water tank and take the brush out of it.
2. Put the brush in warm water with mild soap and work the bristles until all the glue has gone.
3. For best results, leave it to soak overnight. Several machines' brushes can share one container.
4. Rinse under running warm water.
5. Refit it in a clean tank, shortest bristles towards the machine, bristles flat across the top.

Why: glue in the bristles stops water reaching the tape, so the seal gets weaker.

WEEKLY Wash the water tank

1. Empty the tank.
2. Wash it in warm water with mild soap.
3. Scrub the bottom and the tight corners with a low-scratch scouring brush.
4. Rinse well under running warm water so no soap is left.
5. Refit the brush, then slide the tank in under the heater until it locks onto the shelf.

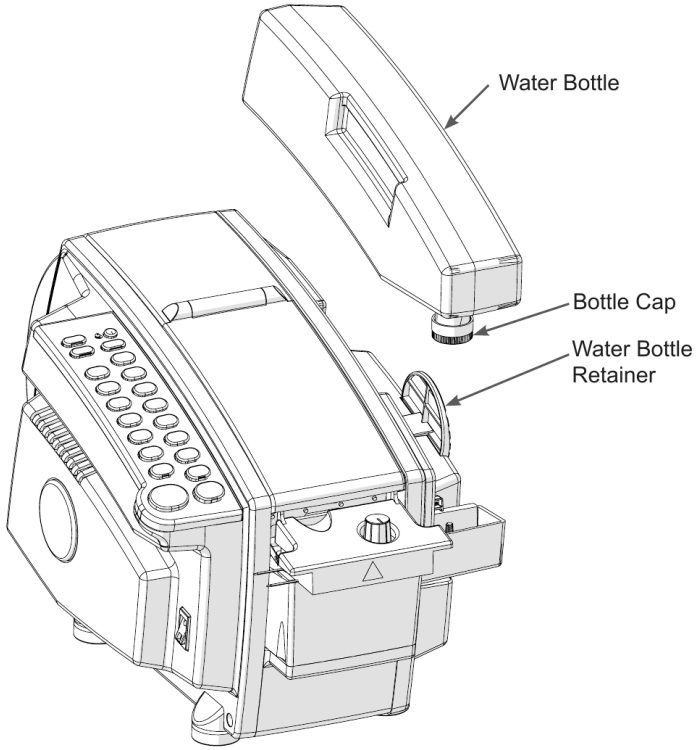
Why: glue settles in the tank, then gets into the brush and cuts the amount of water on the tape.

> **Hot heater.** Lift it only by the grip tabs when you slide the tank back in.

Also weekly: clear the dust

With the power off, remove built-up dust with a dry brush or a blower.

WEEKLY Wash the water bottle



Manual, Figure 21.

1. Fill the bottle a quarter to half full with warm soapy water.
2. Screw the cap on and shake hard.
3. Let it drain, then rinse with warm water.
4. Let it dry completely before you use it again.

Hard water leaves scale. Filtered water makes the brush and the cap seal last longer. In bad cases a white vinegar and water rinse works, but replacing the bottle and cap is the better fix.

MONTHLY Blade and felt pads

1. Power off, unplug and put on cut-resistant gloves.
2. Scrape the built-up glue off the blade with a scraper.
3. Put a light coat of light machine oil on the **back** of the blade.
4. Add just a few drops of light machine oil to the felt pads.

> **Do not scrape the cutting edge.** It damages the blade and can mean replacing it.

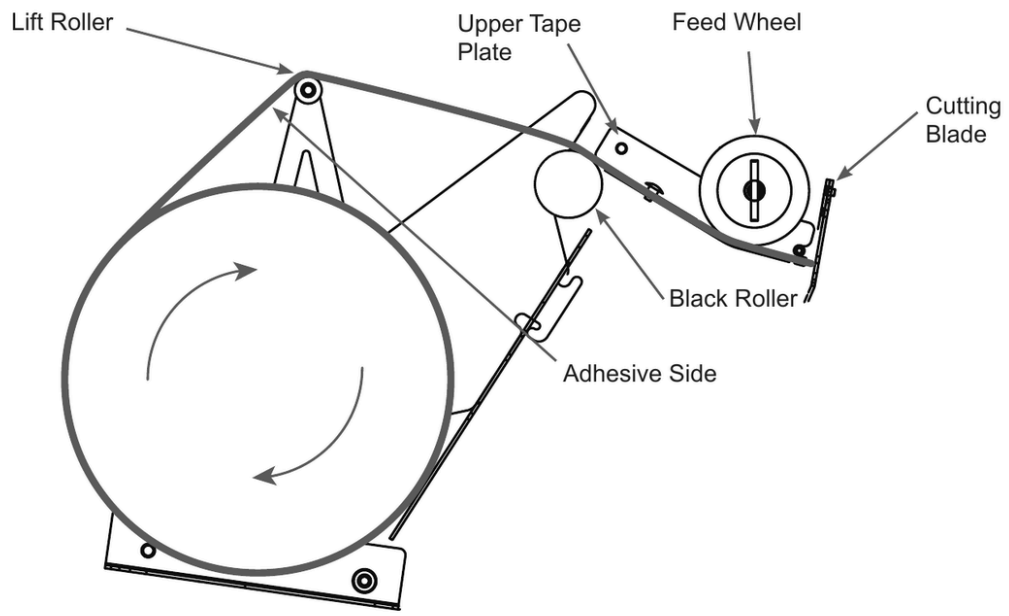
This is a maintenance person's job (Skill B in the manual), with the power disconnected.

ANNUALLY Inside, heater plates and covers

1. Power off, unplug and let the heater cool for at least 30 minutes.
2. Clear every bit of tape, dust and anything else from inside the machine with a dry brush or blower.
3. Clean the built-up tape glue off the bottom of the heater and the pressure plates.
4. Wipe all the covers with a damp rag.

Your maintenance person's job, with the power disconnected. Ask Cotswold Packaging about the Better Packages mail-in factory maintenance programme.

AS NEEDED Upper tape plate and tape path



Tape path, manual Figure 16.

1. Power off and open the lid.
2. Hold the upper tape plate by its bent top edge and slide it out towards the back.
3. Check the tape path is clean and dry.
4. Slide the plate back so it sits under the guide bar near the blade and around the feed wheel.

> **The plate must be fitted.** If it is missing or out of place, the tape will jam.

Back in service

- Brush in, shortest bristles towards the machine, lying flat across the tank
- Tank locked onto its shelf
- Bottle filled, on its shelf, cap around the post
- Upper tape plate seated, tape loaded up to the blade
- Lid closed and square

1. Plug in. **Main Power Switch** to **I**. Wait for the beep.
2. Set the **Heater Control Dial**.
3. Feed a test piece and check it is evenly wet and feels oily.

Schedule at a glance

HOW OFTEN	TASK	USE	WHO
Weekly	Wash the brush, soak overnight if you can	Mild soap, warm water	Operator
Weekly	Wash the water tank	Mild soap, warm water, low-scratch brush	Operator
Weekly	Wash the water bottle	Warm soapy water, shake, rinse, dry	Operator
Weekly	Clear dust	Dry brush or blower	Operator
Monthly	Scrape glue off the blade, not the cutting edge	Scraper, cut-resistant gloves	Maintenance
Monthly	Oil the back of the blade and the felt pads	Light machine oil	Maintenance
Annually	Clear the inside, clean heater bottom and pressure plates, wipe covers	Dry brush or blower, damp rag	Maintenance
As needed	Check upper tape plate and tape path	Hands only	Operator